

Overview of Veterans Small Business Resource Guide

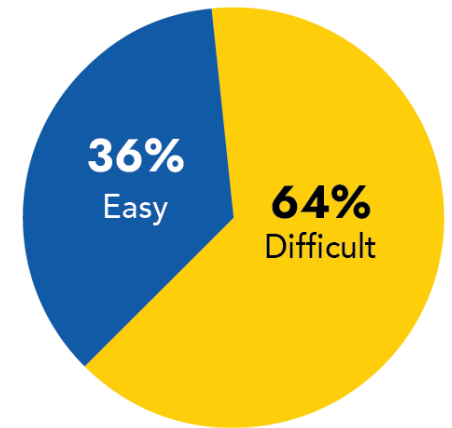
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Transition Challenges for Veterans

- Largest stressor during transitioning is finding suitable employment (2/3 of Veterans)
- Veterans are significantly more likely to be underemployed than nonveterans
- 35% of surveyed Veterans are likely to pursue entrepreneurship
- Veterans are approx. 5% of population but own 10% of small businesses and 14% of franchises
- 85% of veteran-owned businesses consider themselves successful (*Institute for Veterans and Military Families 2022 survey*)
- U.S. Bureau of Labor Data for All Small Businesses
 - 45% fail during first 5 years
 - 65% fail during first 10 years

Ease of transition to civilian life



Reasons Why Veterans Make Successful Entrepreneurs



1 Strong leadership skills

2 Adaptability and problem-solving abilities

3 Discipline and work ethic

4 Resilience and determination

Unique Small Business Opportunities for Veterans vs. Civilian Population

- Veterans have additional loans and grant funding available to them that are not available to civilians
- Service-Disabled Veterans can bid on set-aside (5%) Federal Government contracts not eligible to civilians
- Take advantage of Veterans Employment and Training Service through Department of Labor
- Use networking strategies with other veterans to uncover new business contacts and opportunities
- Differentiate small businesses as being Veteran-owned through marketing programs to both Veteran and civilian populations

SCORE Veterans Small Business Resource Guide



You served us. Now we serve you.

Veterans Resource Guide - Course Content

Guide contains SCORE and SBA curated resources

- Used in conjunction with SCORE mentoring sessions
- Includes webinars, courses, and articles
- Mentors have complete flexibility to use Resource Guide materials or substitute with other SCORE materials as preferred
- 7 SCORE resources specifically for Veterans
- Includes section on Veteran funding opportunities through SBA/VBOC

Veterans Resource Guide - Course Content

Resource Guide has been extensively market research tested with:

- Veterans
- Veteran Leadership
- SBA Leadership
- SCORE Leadership
- SCORE Mentors

SCORE Assists Entrepreneurs in All Stages of Small Business Life Cycle

Starting a Business → Growing a Business → Selling a Business

- Building a New Business
- Buying Existing Business
- Buying a Franchise

Finding Funding / SBA

Rob Goza

Lead Economic Development Specialist

SBA Eastern Pennsylvania District Office

Finding Funding

The Startup Roadmap: Finding Funding

ONLINE COURSE •
★★★★★



TAKE THE COURSE

***Note:**

SCORE assists in accessing potential sources of funding

SCORE does not provide grants or loans

SCORE Webinar: [The Startup Roadmap: Finding Funding](#)

Finding Funding - SCORE is a Resource Partner with SBA

Need a Business Loan to Start, Grow, or Expand?



The SBA works with approved lenders to offer **microloans** and **SBA-backed loans** with:

- Competitive terms
- Lower down payments
- Flexible overhead requirements
- Counseling and education



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Finding Funding – SBA Funding Programs



Loans

Start or expand your business with loans guaranteed by the Small Business Administration.



Investment capital

Find an investor for your business. Investors make both debt and equity investments.



Disaster assistance

Get help after a disaster with low-interest disaster loans from the Small Business Administration.



Surety bonds

Protect your work and your client with an SBA-guaranteed surety bond.

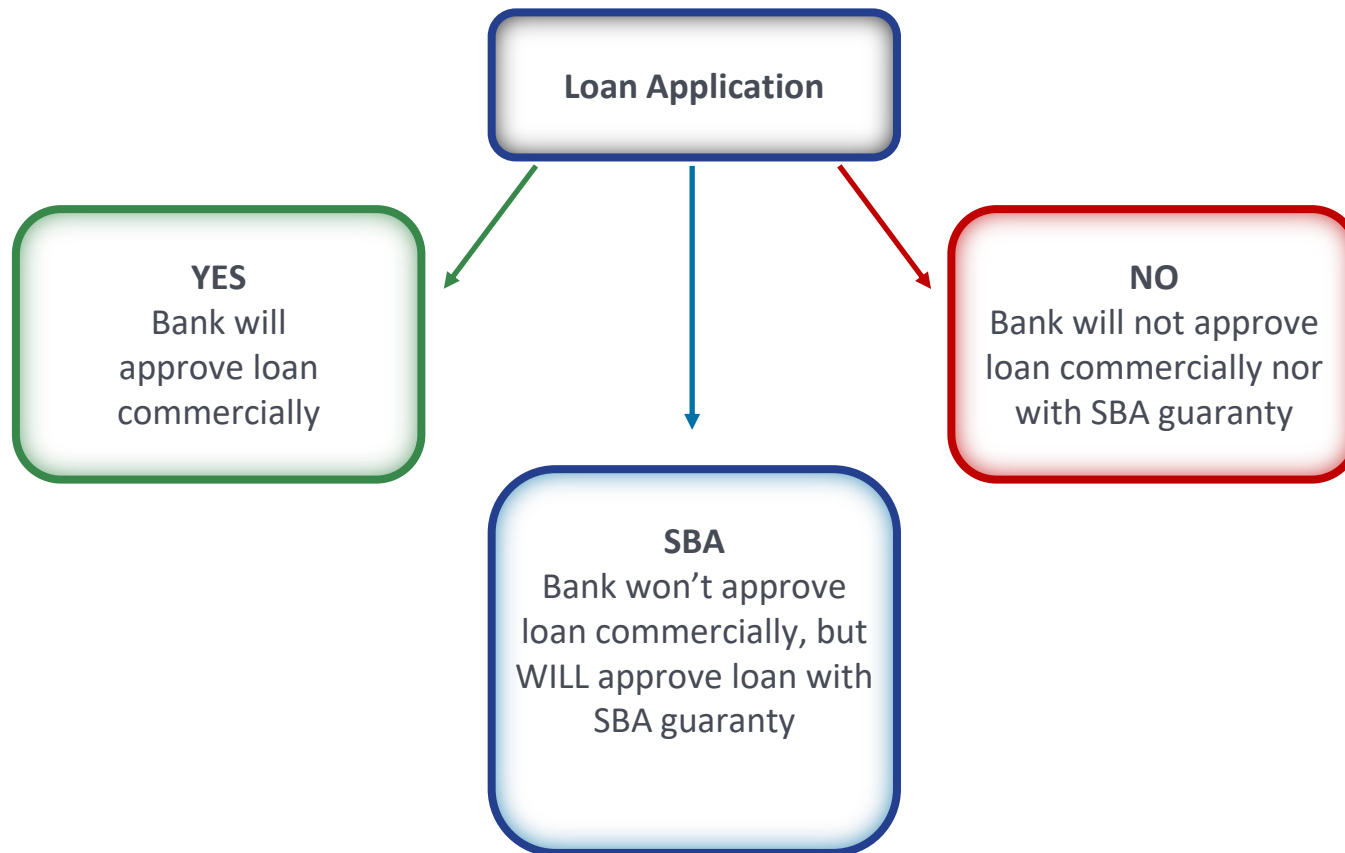


Grants

Look for government grants that help businesses do scientific research and development.

Finding Funding –Bank Loans & SBA 7A Guarantees

When Does the Bank Use SBA?



Finding Funding – SBA Lender Match Services

Lender Match

Lender Match connects you to lenders by getting matched to potential lenders offering SBA-backed funding:

- Using Lender Match doesn't guarantee that you'll get matched or be offered a loan.
- Ask lenders about interest rates, minimum credit score, cash flow requirements, and other qualifying factors.
- Lender Match submits loan requests to participating Community Development Financial Institutions and small asset lenders.
- Find an SBA-approved lender at SBA.gov/lendermatch



Additional Funding Opportunities

Best Small Business Financing Options for Women in 2023

by Rieva Lesonsky • March 2, 2023 •
★★★★★



12 Funding Options for Black-Owned Businesses

by Brett Farmiloe • February 19, 2024 •
★★★★★



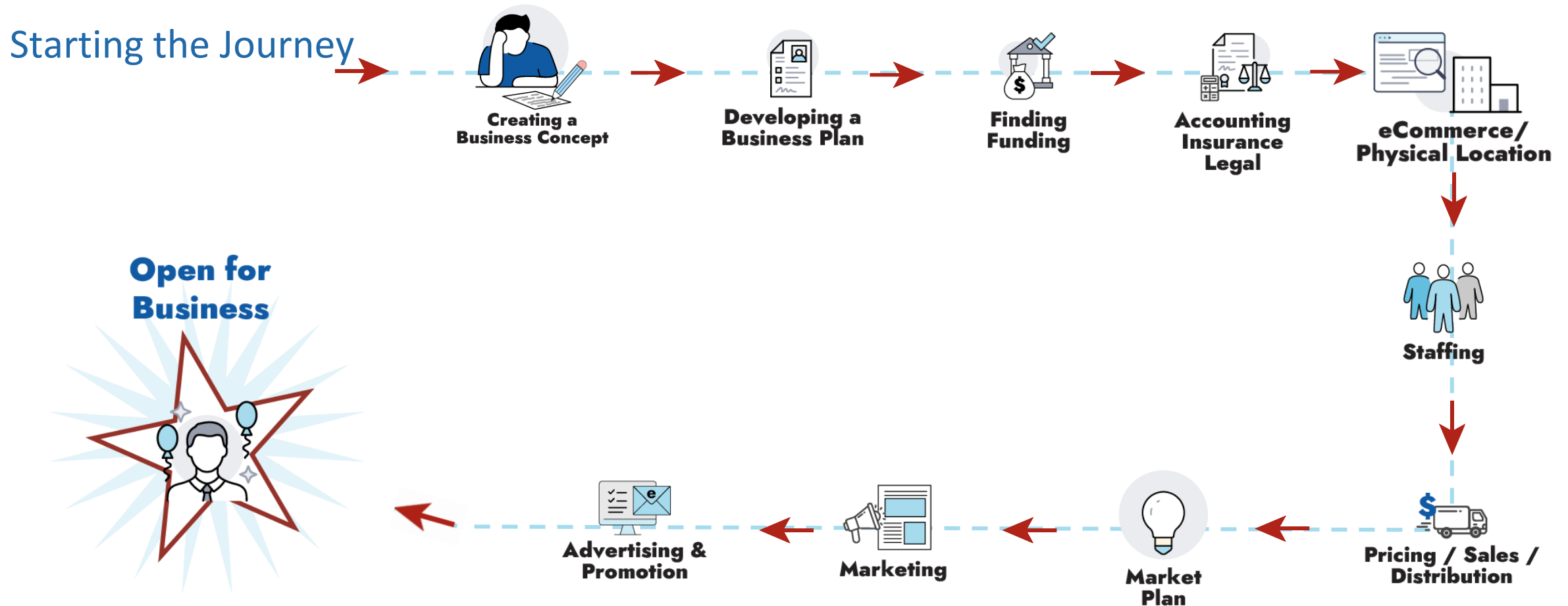
11 Funding Resources for Hispanic and Latino Small Business Owners

by Maria Valdez Haubrich • January 24, 2024 •
★★★★★



Roadmap for Success - Curriculum

Veterans Small Businesses – Roadmap for Success



*Note –these activities can be reordered to meet specific business needs

Sample Section - Creating a Business Concept

Are You the Next Veteran Entrepreneur? Vet-to-Vet Advice About Business Ownership

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 1.5 Hours

Language: English

[VIEW WEBINAR](#)

Viewing this webinar requires some basic information. This data is only used within SCORE and will not be distributed to any third parties.

SCORE Webinar: [Are You the Next Veteran Entrepreneur? Vet-to-Vet Advice About Business Ownership](#)

Sample Section - Marketing

Marketing Tips for Your Veteran-Owned Business



by Lee Mills

• November 9, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Marketing Tips for Your Veteran-Owned Business](#)

Sample Section - Marketing (cont'd)

Win Customers: Turn Military Speak into Civilian Speak



by Matt Louis

• October 31, 2023 •



SCORE Article: [Win Customers: Turn Military Speak into Civilian Speak](#)

Sample Section - Growing a Business

Growth Strategies for Veteran Entrepreneurs

October 31, 2023 •



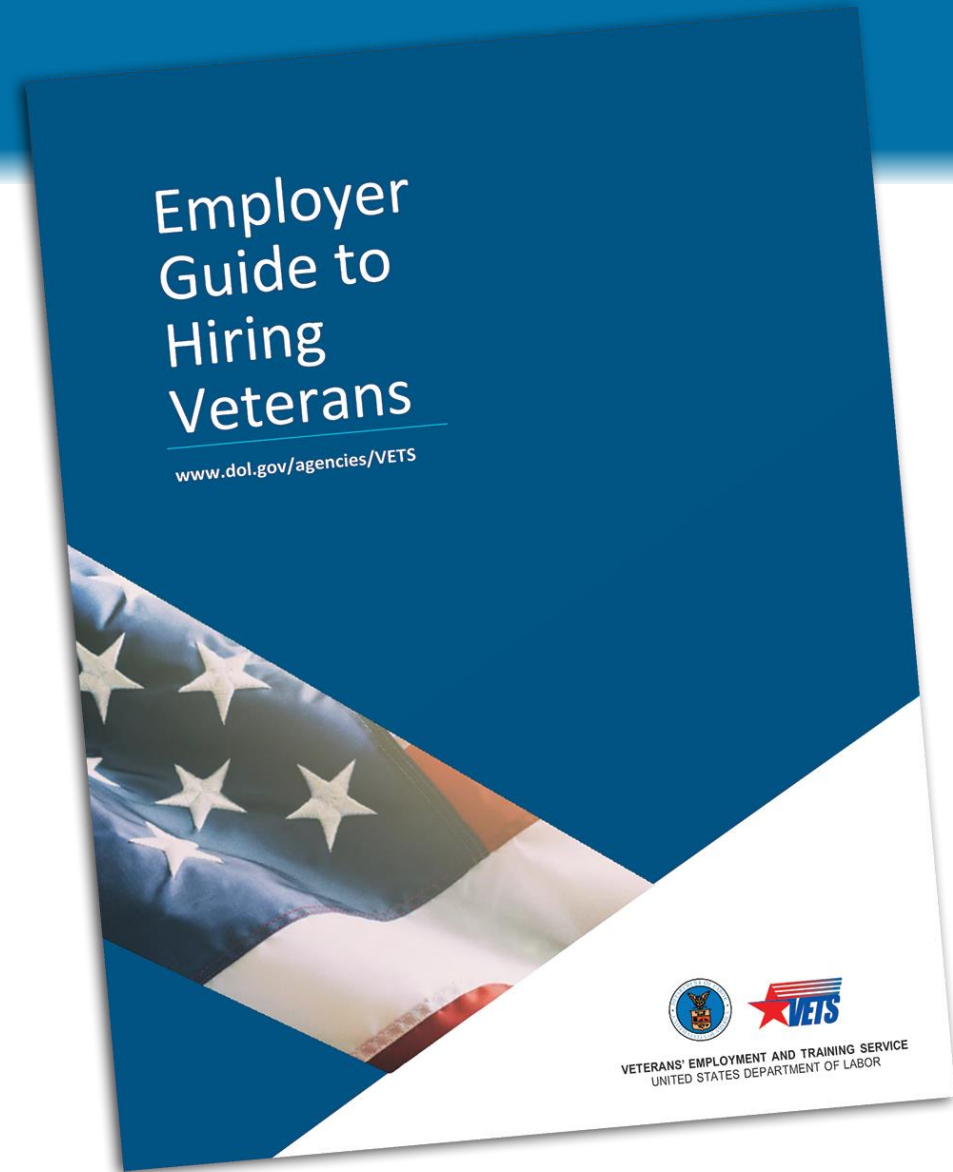
SCORE Article: [Growth Strategies for Veteran Entrepreneurs](#)

Sample Section - Staffing



VETERANS' EMPLOYMENT AND TRAINING SERVICE
UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF LABOR

SCORE Webinar: [Employer Guide to Hiring Veterans](https://www.dol.gov/agencies/VETS)



Contracting Program for Service-Disabled Veterans



Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business program

Program benefits

The federal government aims to award at least 5% of all federal contracting dollars to SDVOSBs each year.

Competition is limited for certain federal contract opportunities to businesses that participate in the SDVOSB program.

Joining the SDVOSB program makes your business eligible to compete for the program's [set-aside and sole source contracts](#).

SBA Resource: [Service-Disabled Veteran-Owned Small Business program](#)





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Selling a Business

How to Sell your Business

RECORDED WEBINAR (ONLINE) •



Duration: 60 minutes

Language: English

VIEW WEBINAR

Viewing this webinar requires some basic information. This data is only used within SCORE and will not be distributed to any third parties.

<https://www.score.org/palmbeachcounty/event/how-sell-your-business-1>

<https://www.score.org/longisland/resource/eguide/exiting-or-selling-a-business>

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- Buying Existing Business
- Buying a Franchise

Next Steps

- Distribution of Mentors Guide
- Follow-up Online Sessions to provide mentors with training on use of Mentors Guide